

5과 많이 아프면 이 약을 드세요

Chapter 5 — If it hurts a lot, take this medicine

This chapter at a glance

주제	Topic 약국 — the pharmacy
어휘와 문법	Vocabulary & grammar 약, 증상 관련 어휘 / 동형-으면 / 동-어서(순차) — medicines and symptoms · if · doing one thing and then the next
활동	Activities 약국에서 약 사기, 아픈 친구에게 조언하는 글 쓰기 — buying medicine at the pharmacy; writing advice to a friend who is ill
문화와 정보	Culture & information 휴일지킴이 약국 — pharmacies that open on holidays

Being ill in a language you are still learning is frightening, and this chapter is the practical answer to it: how to name what hurts, how long it has hurt, and what to ask for. Learn the symptom phrases until they come out without effort — you will want them on a day when you feel too poor to think.

In Korea the pharmacist is the first stop, not the last. For a cold, a stomach upset or a small cut you go to the 약국 and describe the symptom, and they choose the medicine. That is why this chapter teaches the pharmacy rather than the hospital.

The two grammar points divide the conversation. 동형-으면 is the condition — 많이 아프면, if it hurts a lot — and 동-어서 chains the actions the pharmacist tells you to take: 죽을 끓여서 드세요, boil some porridge and eat it. The chapter title is the pharmacist's own sentence.

도입

Warm-up

이 사람들은 어디가 아파요?

Where does it hurt, for each of these people?

여러분은 언제 약국에 갔어요?

When did you last go to a pharmacy?

What the original page shows

약국 1

a woman leaning on the counter holding her stomach while the pharmacists look for something

약국 2

a man with a cut hand being given a dressing across the counter

약국 3

the shelves themselves — boxes of tablets, bottles, and 파스 patches

The green cross and the character 약 are what you look for on a street. Both are used on signs, and the shop itself is 약국 — the word ends in 국, the same 국 as in 우체국, the post office.

어디가 아파요? is asked with 어디 — 'where' — not 'what'. Korean asks which part of you hurts, so the answer names the body part: 머리가 아파요, 배가 아파요. Learn the question and the answer as a pair.

어휘와 문법 1

Vocabulary & grammar 1

어디가 아파요?

Where does it hurt?

증상 — symptoms

열이 나다

to have a temperature

머리가 아프다

to have a headache

이가 아프다

to have toothache

배가 아프다 / 설사를 하다

to have a stomach ache / to have diarrhoea

다리를 다치다

to injure a leg

콧물이 나다

to have a runny nose

기침을 하다

to have a cough

목이 붓다

to have a swollen throat

팔이 부러지다

to break an arm

가 어디가 아파요?

Where does it hurt?

나 열이 나고, 기침을 해요.

I've got a temperature and a cough.

나다 means 'to come out', and Korean uses it for anything the body produces by itself: 열이 나다, 콧물이 나다. The symptom is the subject and takes 이/가 — it happens to you rather than being something you do.

Compare 부러지다 and 다치다. 부러지다 is a clean break, used of bones, and it happens to the part: 팔이 부러지다. 다치다 is any injury, and the part is the object: 다리를 다치다. The particles are the giveaway — 이/가 with the first, 을/를 with the second.

붓다 is a ㅅ irregular: the ㅅ drops before a vowel, so 목이 부어요, not 붓어요. You will meet the same verb for a swollen leg — 다리가 부었어요 — in the practice on the next grammar page.

여러분은 언제, 어디가 아팠어요? 이야기해 보세요.

When were you last unwell, and what hurt? Talk about it.

지난 주말에 축구를 했어요. 운동장에서 넘어져서 다리를 다쳤어요.

I played football last weekend. I fell over on the pitch and hurt my leg.

넘어져서 다리를 다쳤어요 is this chapter's second grammar point arriving early — one thing happened and then the next. You will meet 동-어서 properly two pages on.

동형-으면

Verb/Adjective + -으면 — if, when

앞 내용이 뒤 내용의 조건이나 가정이 될 때 사용해요.

Used when the first part is the condition or supposition for the second.

가 머리가 아프고 열이 나요.
I've got a headache and a temperature.

나 많이 아프면 병원에 가 보세요.
If it's bad, go and see a doctor.

예문 — Examples

가 가족들이 한국에 오면 뭐 하고 싶어요?
What would you like to do when your family come to Korea?

나 같이 제주도에 가고 싶어요.
I'd like to go to Jeju together.

시간이 있으면 밥 먹을까요?
If you have time, shall we get something to eat?

방학을 하면 고향에 가서 부모님을 만날 거예요.
When the holidays start I'll go home and see my parents.

Which form do I use?

-으면 after a final consonant (받침)
먹다 → 먹으면 · 있다 → 있으면

-면 after a vowel
다치다 → 다치면 · ★만들다 → 만들면

Korean does not separate 'if' from 'when' the way English does. 방학을 하면 is 'when the holidays start', 많이 아프면 is 'if it hurts a lot', and the form is identical — the context decides which English word fits.

The ★ on 만들다 is the ㄹ stem again, and it behaves differently here from the last chapter. Before -으면 the ㄹ simply stays and no 으 is added: 만들면. Compare 만들 수 있어요 from chapter 4 — same stem, same principle, no extra vowel.

-으면 is how advice is given politely in Korean. 많이 아프면 병원에 가 보세요 leaves the judgement with the listener: it is their decision whether it hurts a lot. Plain 병원에 가세요 would be an instruction.

연습 1 — 이 사람들은 고민이 있어요. 좋은 방법을 이야기해 주세요.

가 어제부터 기침을 계속 해요.
I've had a cough since yesterday.

나 기침을 계속 하면 따뜻한 차를 마셔 보세요.
If the cough keeps on, try drinking something warm.

1) 요즘 배가 많이 나오다 → 자전거를 타다
putting on weight around the middle → cycle

2) 요즘 밤에 잠이 안 오다 → 커피를 조금만 마시다
not sleeping at night → drink less coffee

3) 자주 다리가 붓다 → 마사지를 하다
legs often swelling → massage them

연습 2 — 여러분은 어떻게 할 거예요? 이야기해 보세요.

한국어를 잘하면 뭐 하고 싶어요?

What would you like to do once your Korean is good?

가족들이 한국에 오면 뭐 할 거예요?

What will you do when your family come to Korea?

돈이 많으면 뭘 사고 싶어요?

What would you buy if you had a lot of money?

어휘와 문법 2

Vocabulary & grammar 2

어디가 아파요? 무슨 약이 필요해요?

Where does it hurt? What medicine do you need?

먹는 약 — medicine you take

해열제

something for a temperature

두통약

painkiller for a headache

감기약

cold medicine

소화제

something for indigestion

바르고 붙이는 것 — what you put on the skin

파스를 붙이다

to stick on a medicated patch

밴드를 붙이다

to put on a plaster

소독약을 바르다

to apply antiseptic

연고를 바르다

to apply ointment

가 열이 나요.
I've got a temperature.

나 그럼 해열제를 드세요.
Then take something for the fever.

The 제 in 해열제 and 소화제 means 'agent, preparation', and 해열 is 'reducing heat', 소화 is 'digestion'. Once you see the pattern the names stop being arbitrary — they are descriptions of what the medicine does.

붙이다 and 바르다 divide the skin remedies between them. 붙이다 is to stick something on that stays put — a plaster, a 파스. 바르다 is to spread something — ointment, antiseptic. The verb tells you the form of the medicine before you have seen it.

파스 has no real English equivalent. It is an adhesive medicated pad for aching muscles and joints, sold everywhere and used constantly in Korea. If your shoulder aches, this is what you will be handed.

여러분은 어디가 아팠어요? 약국에서 무슨 약을 샀어요?

What was wrong with you, and what did you buy at the pharmacy?

저는 지난번에 머리가 아파서 두통약을 샀어요.

Last time I had a headache, so I bought a painkiller.

아파서 here is 아/어서 giving a reason, not the sequence use taught on the next page. The same ending does both jobs; with a state like 아프다 it is a reason, with an action like 가다 it is a sequence.

동-어서(순차)

Verb + -어서 — and then, in sequence

서로 관련이 있는 두 행동이 시간적으로 이어서 일어남을 말할 때 사용해요.

Used when two related actions happen one after the other.

가 아침부터 소화가 잘 안 돼요.
My digestion has been off since this morning.

나 약국에 가서 소화제를 사 올게요.
I'll go to the pharmacy and get you something for it.

예문 — Examples

가 제이슨 씨, 점심 먹었어요?
Jason, have you had lunch?

나 네, 편의점에서 도시락을 사서 먹었어요.
Yes, I bought a lunchbox at the convenience store and ate it.

지난 주말에 친구를 만나서 같이 영화를 봤어요.
Last weekend I met a friend and we saw a film together.

저는 집에서 요리해서 먹어요.
I cook at home and eat there.

The three endings

-아서	stem vowel ㅏ or ㅑ 오다 → 와서 · 만나다 → 만나서
-어서	any other stem vowel 만들다 → 만들어서 · 기다리다 → 기다려서
-해서	하다 verbs 공부하다 → 공부해서 · 운동하다 → 운동해서

The two actions must be connected — the second is done with or to the thing from the first. 도시락을 사서 먹었어요 means you ate the lunchbox you bought. For two unrelated actions in order you would use -고 instead.

Never put a tense on the first verb. 사서 먹었어요, not 샀아서 먹었어요. The final verb carries the tense for the whole sentence — one of the tidier things about Korean, and a very common learner mistake.

Compare with 동-은 다음에 from chapter 2. 밥을 먹은 다음에 약을 드세요 simply orders two separate events. 약국에 가서 약을 사세요 ties them: you buy the medicine at the pharmacy you went to. 다음에 is sequence, -어서 is sequence with a link.

연습 1 — 여러분은 어떻게 해요? 이야기해 보세요.

보기) 케이크를 먹어요 — 집에서 만들다 / 제과점에서 사다
cake — make it at home / buy it at the bakery

1) 음식을 먹어요 — 직접 요리하다 / 배달시키다
food — cook it yourself / order a delivery

2) 영화를 봐요 — 영화관에 가다 / 내려받다 (다운로드 받다)
films — go to the cinema / download them

3) 물을 마셔요 — 집에서 끓이다 / 마트에서 사다

water — boil it at home / buy it at the shop

가 케이크를 집에서 만들어서 먹어요, 제과점에서 사서 먹어요?

Do you make cake at home and eat it, or buy it from a bakery?

나 저는 집에서 만들어서 먹어요.

I make it at home.

연습 2 — 다음을 친구에게 물어보고 함께 이야기해 보세요.**아침에 일어나서 제일 먼저 뭐 해요?**

What's the first thing you do after getting up?

수업이 끝난 다음에 집에 가서 뭐 해요?

What do you do when you get home after class?

친구를 만나서 뭐 해요?

What do you do when you meet friends?

말하기와 듣기

Speaking & listening

약국에서 약사와 이야기해요. 다음과 같이 이야기해 보세요.

Talking to the pharmacist. Practise the exchange.

약사 어떻게 오셨어요?

What can I do for you?

이링 배가 아프고 설사를 해요.

I've got a stomach ache and diarrhoea.

약사 언제부터 아팠어요?

Since when?

이링 오늘 아침부터 아팠어요.

Since this morning.

약사 그럼 이 약을 지금 드세요. 그래도 계속 아프면 하루에 두 번, 아침과 저녁에 드세요. 그리고 죽을 끓여서 드세요.

Then take this now. If it still hurts, take it twice a day, morning and evening. And make yourself some rice porridge.

Swap in these sets

1) 배가 아프고 설사를 하다 | 하루에 두 번, 아침과 저녁에 먹다, 죽을 끓여서 먹다

stomach ache and diarrhoea — twice a day morning and evening, and make porridge

2) 열이 나고 머리가 아프다 | 병원에 가 보다, 집에 가서 꼭 쉬다

temperature and headache — see a doctor, go home and rest properly

어떻게 오셨어요? is literally 'how did you come?', but it means 'what brings you in?'. Every pharmacy, clinic and office asks it. Answer with the symptom, not with how you travelled.

언제부터 — 'since when' — is the pharmacist's second question, every time. Have an answer ready: 오늘 아침부터, 어제부터, 일주일 전부터. How long it has gone on decides what they give you.

죽 is rice porridge, and it is what Koreans eat when ill — plain, warm and easy on the stomach. Being told to make some is medical advice, not a change of subject. Shops selling nothing else exist for exactly this.

연습 2 — 아파서 약국에 왔어요. 약국에서 약을 사 보세요.

어떻게 오셨어요?

What can I do for you?

어디가 아프세요?

Where does it hurt?

듣기 — 잠시드 씨가 아파서 약국에 갔어요. 잘 듣고 답해 보세요.

1) 잠시드 씨는 어디가 아파요?

What is wrong with Jamshid?

2) 약국에서 어떤 약을 샀어요?

What did he buy? (four to choose from: cold medicine, ointment, a plaster, tablets)

읽기와 쓰기

Reading & writing

다음 글을 읽고 질문에 답해 보세요.

Read the label and answer the questions.

약 봉투 — the medicine envelope

라민 귀하

For Ramin

남 · 여 25세

male / female — 25 years old

용법: 1일 2회 (아침, 저녁) 3일분

Directions: twice a day (morning, evening), three days' supply

식후 30분

30 minutes after eating (ticked)

행복 약국

Happiness Pharmacy

Questions

1) ① 이 약은 하루에 세 번 먹어요.

— twice a day, not three times

1) ② 이 약은 점심에 먹지 않아요.

○ — only morning and evening

1) ③ 라민 씨는 스물다섯 살이에요.

○ — 25세

2) 이 약은 며칠 동안 먹어요?

→ 3일 동안 먹어요

3) 이 약은 언제 먹어요?

→ 아침과 저녁, 식후 30분에 먹어요

Learn to read this envelope — every prescription in Korea comes in one. 1일 2회 is doses per day, 3일분 is how many days' worth, and the ticked box says when relative to food. Those three facts are the whole label.

식전 is before eating, 식후 is after. 전 and 후 are the same characters you meet in 오전 and 오후, morning and afternoon. Most Korean medicine is taken 식후 30분 — half an hour after a meal.

회 counts occurrences: 1일 2회 is twice a day. It is the counter used for repetitions of an event, so you will also see it for classes, doses and appointments.

연습 2 — 아픈 사람이 인터넷에 질문을 했어요. 어떻게 하면 좋을까요? 댓글을 써 보세요.

여러분 안녕하세요? 저는 필리핀에서 온 마리셀이에요.

Hello everyone. I'm Maricel, from the Philippines.

저에게 한국의 겨울 날씨는 너무 추워요.

Korean winters are far too cold for me.

그래서 어제부터 기침을 하고 콧물이 나요. 열도 있어요.

Since yesterday I've had a cough and a runny nose, and a temperature as well.

어떻게 하면 좋을까요?

What would you suggest?

어떻게 하면 좋을까요? is how you ask for advice online or in person — 'what would be good if I did what?'. It uses this chapter's -으면, and it is worth keeping whole as a phrase.

단어장 — New words

용법

directions for use

식전

before eating

회

times (counter)

식후

after eating

분

portion, supply

댓글

a reply, a comment

문화와 정보 — 휴일지킴이 약국

Culture & information — Holiday-duty pharmacies

한국에서는 편의점에서도 해열제, 진통제, 소화제, 감기약, 파스를 살 수 있습니다.

In Korea you can buy fever medicine, painkillers, indigestion tablets, cold medicine and 파스 at convenience stores too.

하지만 대부분의 약들은 약국에서 삽니다.

But most medicines are bought at a pharmacy.

휴일에 약이 필요하면 어떻게 할까요?

So what do you do if you need medicine on a holiday?

그러면 휴일지킴이 약국을 찾아보세요.

Look for a 휴일지킴이 pharmacy.

휴일지킴이 약국은 휴일에도 문을 엽니다.

These open on holidays as well.

휴일지킴이 약국 홈페이지에 접속하면 휴일지킴이 약국을 찾을 수 있습니다.

Go to the 휴일지킴이 website and you can find one.

그리고 필요한 약 정보도 확인할 수 있습니다.

You can also look up information about the medicine you need.

지킴이 means 'keeper' or 'guardian', so 휴일지킴이 is 'the one who keeps watch on holidays'. The word turns up all over Korean public services for whoever is on duty when everything else is shut.

The convenience store list is worth memorising, because it is what you can get at three in the morning: 해열제, 진통제, 소화제, 감기약, 파스. Anything beyond those five needs a pharmacy.

The page uses both of this chapter's grammar points in one sentence — 홈페이지에 접속하면 ... 찾을 수 있습니다, with 동-을 수 있다 from chapter 4 as well. Read it as revision rather than as new material.

Questions

1) 약을 어디에서 살 수 있어요?

→ 약국과 편의점에서 살 수 있어요

2) 휴일지킴이 약국은 어떤 약국이에요?

→ 휴일에도 문을 여는 약국이에요

3) 여러분 고향에서는 어디에서 약을 살 수 있어요?

→ Where do you buy medicine back home?

발음 · 배운 어휘 확인

Pronunciation · Vocabulary checklist

발음 1 — 다음을 듣고 따라 읽으세요.

놓지 [노치]

the ㅎ merges with the ㅈ to give 치

좋지요 [조치요]

and again with ㅈ, giving 치

어떻게 [어떠케]

the same merger, this time with ㄱ giving 케

A ㅎ in the 받침 does not disappear — it fuses with the next consonant and aspirates it. ㅎ + ㄱ becomes ㅋ, ㅎ + ㄷ becomes ㅌ, ㅎ + ㅈ becomes ㅊ. That single rule explains all three examples here.

This is why 어떻게 is heard as [어떠케] — and it is one of the most common words in the language, appearing twice in this chapter's pharmacy dialogue alone. Get it right once and it stays right.

발음 2 — 다음을 듣고 연습해 보세요.

가 여기에 물건을 놓지 마세요.
Please don't put things here.

나 네, 알겠습니다.
Right, understood.

가 어떻게 오셨어요?
What can I do for you?

나 머리가 아파요.
I've got a headache.

가 같이 밥을 먹을까요?
Shall we eat together?

나 좋지요.
Yes, let's.

배운 어휘 확인 — Vocabulary checklist

열이 나다

to have a temperature

소화제

something for indigestion

콧물이 나다

to have a runny nose

파스

medicated patch

머리가 아프다

to have a headache

밴드

plaster

기침을 하다

to cough

붙이다

to stick on

이가 아프다

to have toothache

소독약

antiseptic

목이 붓다

to have a swollen throat

연고

ointment

배가 아프다

to have a stomach ache

바르다

to apply, to spread on

설사를 하다

to have diarrhoea

용법

directions for use

부러지다

to break (a bone)

회

times (counter)

다치다

to injure

분

portion, supply

해열제

fever medicine

식전

before eating

두통약

headache tablets

식후

after eating

감기약

cold medicine

덧글

a reply, a comment